



UAE schools clamp down on digital shortcuts

ABU DHABI
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In a move that seeks to encourage students to engage in independent thinking, foster healthy competition and prevent the misuse of AI tools in homework and assessment, several schools in the UAE are taking steps to block access to ChatGPT.

As AI-powered chatbots like ChatGPT become more pervasive, educators are concerned that students' over-dependence on technology could hinder the development of crucial skills such as problem-solving, critical thinking, and creativity.

With these new regulations, schools are ensuring that students complete their assignments and evaluations without digital shortcuts.

In this regard, institutions have ramped up efforts to raise awareness among students with workshops to educate them.

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GAZA

At least 41 Palestinians were killed in Israeli airstrikes in the Gaza Strip during the past 24 hours, raising the death toll since October 2023 to 50,021, the Health Ministry said yesterday.

The ministry said 61 more injured were transferred to hospitals, taking the number of injuries to 113,274.

The Israeli military yesterday said it had encircled a district in Rafah in southern Gaza where it had earlier warned civilians to leave.

Israeli troops have "in recent hours" encircled Tal Al Sultan in Rafah, the military said in a statement, adding its objective was to "dismantle terrorist infrastructure and eliminate" militants there.

'Dangerous combat zone'

In a statement on X, military spokesman Avichay Adraee said the army "launched an offensive to strike the terrorist organisations" in Rafah's Tal Al



■ Palestinians rush an injured girl away from the site of Israeli strikes on a makeshift displacement camp in central Gaza City, yesterday.
AFP

Sultan district. Adraee called on Palestinians in the area to leave the "dangerous combat zone" and move further north.

Earlier on Saturday, an Israeli air strike on a camp in the Khan Younis area killed senior Hamas political official Salah

Al Bardawil and his wife, the group said.

Later today, EU foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas will visit Israel and the occupied Palestinian territories to urge an immediate resumption of the Gaza ceasefire agreement, her office said.

Meanwhile, Pope Francis yesterday called for an "immediate" end to Israeli strikes on the Gaza Strip, and for resumption of dialogue for release of hostages and a "definitive ceasefire".

— Agencies

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